

# User's Manual

## Overview

This manual documents new features added to Gerrit to improve the code review workflow. The additions reduce the need for duplicated effort and allow for more visibility, which can foster accountability across reviewers. The features are designed for authors and reviewers, and they are fully backwards-compatible with Gerrit's existing review model and functionality.

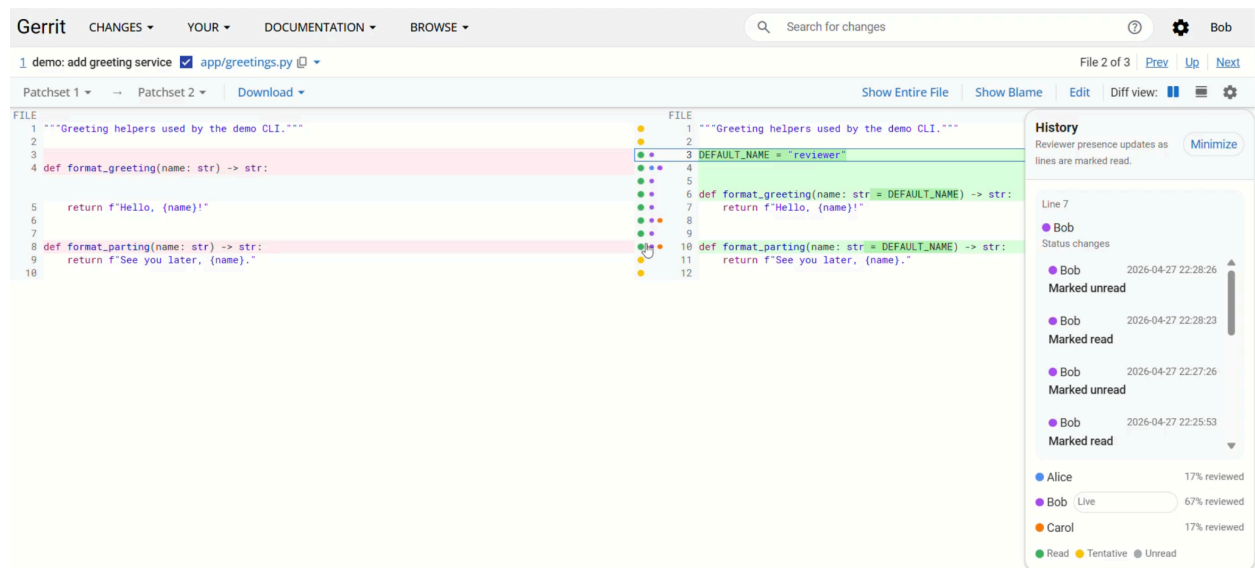
## User Roles

**Authors** create or update changes/code commits for review. Authors can check the progress of the reviewers for their code by looking at the markers next to the lines of code. Authors can also check out the history of the review process by clicking a line and seeing who marked the line as read/unread and at what time. They can also see the progress per reviewer, and follow up as needed.

**Reviewers** look over the submitted code changes. They can toggle the markers next to the lines of code to indicate that they read the line (or toggle again to revert back to unread). With the markers, they know whether they reviewed the line already (whether in the current patchset or a previous patchset), and don't need to review something they already looked at before. Reviewers can look at the progress of other reviewers as well.

**Administrators and other roles** are not directly affected by the new features.

## Feature Overview



The following features are available in the file diff view:

- **Line markers:** A toggleable indicator next to each line showing whether it has been marked as read.

- Reviewer progress panel: A summary showing the percentage of lines read by each reviewer.
- Line review history: A log of all read/unread transitions for a specific line, accessible by clicking the line.
- Tentative read propagation: Lines that are unchanged from a previous patch set are automatically marked as “tentatively read”.

## **Reviewer Guide**

### **Marking Lines as Read**

1. Open a change in Gerrit and navigate to a file in the diff view.
2. Find the marker column to the left of each line number.
3. Click the marker next to a line to toggle it to read. The marker will change appearance to indicate the line has been reviewed.
4. Click the marker again to toggle it back to unread.

### **Marking Multiple Lines at Once**

1. Click and hold the marker next to the first line you want to mark.
2. Drag down to the last line in the range you want to mark.
3. Release to toggle all lines in the range simultaneously.

### **Reviewing Other Reviewers’ Markers**

1. Each reviewer’s markers are displayed with a distinct visual indicator. You can see which lines other reviewers have marked as read directly in the diff view.
2. Reference the legend in the history panel to determine the indicator color associated with each reviewer.

### **Understanding Tentatively Read Lines**

1. When a new patch set is uploaded, lines that are unchanged from the previous patch set are automatically marked as tentatively read. These lines appear in yellow to distinguish them from lines you explicitly mark.
2. A tentatively read line can be toggled to unread by clicking the indicator once, or to read by clicking the indicator again.

### **Checking Reviewer Progress**

1. The reviewer progress panel shows the percentage of lines each reviewer has marked as read for the current file.
2. Click on the panel to show or hide it.

## **Author Guide**

### **Submitting a Change**

1. Commit code to the target repository.

2. Push the change.
3. To update a patch set, amend your commit and push again. Unchanged lines will be automatically propagated as tentatively read for existing reviewers.

### **Monitoring Reviewer Progress**

1. Open your change in Gerrit and navigate to a file.
2. View the reviewer progress panel to see what percentage of lines each reviewer has marked as read.
3. Use this to follow up with reviewers who have not yet completed their review.

### **Viewing the Review History for a Line**

1. Click on a line in the diff view.
2. The history panel will show all read/unread transitions for that line, including each reviewer's name and the timestamp of each transition.